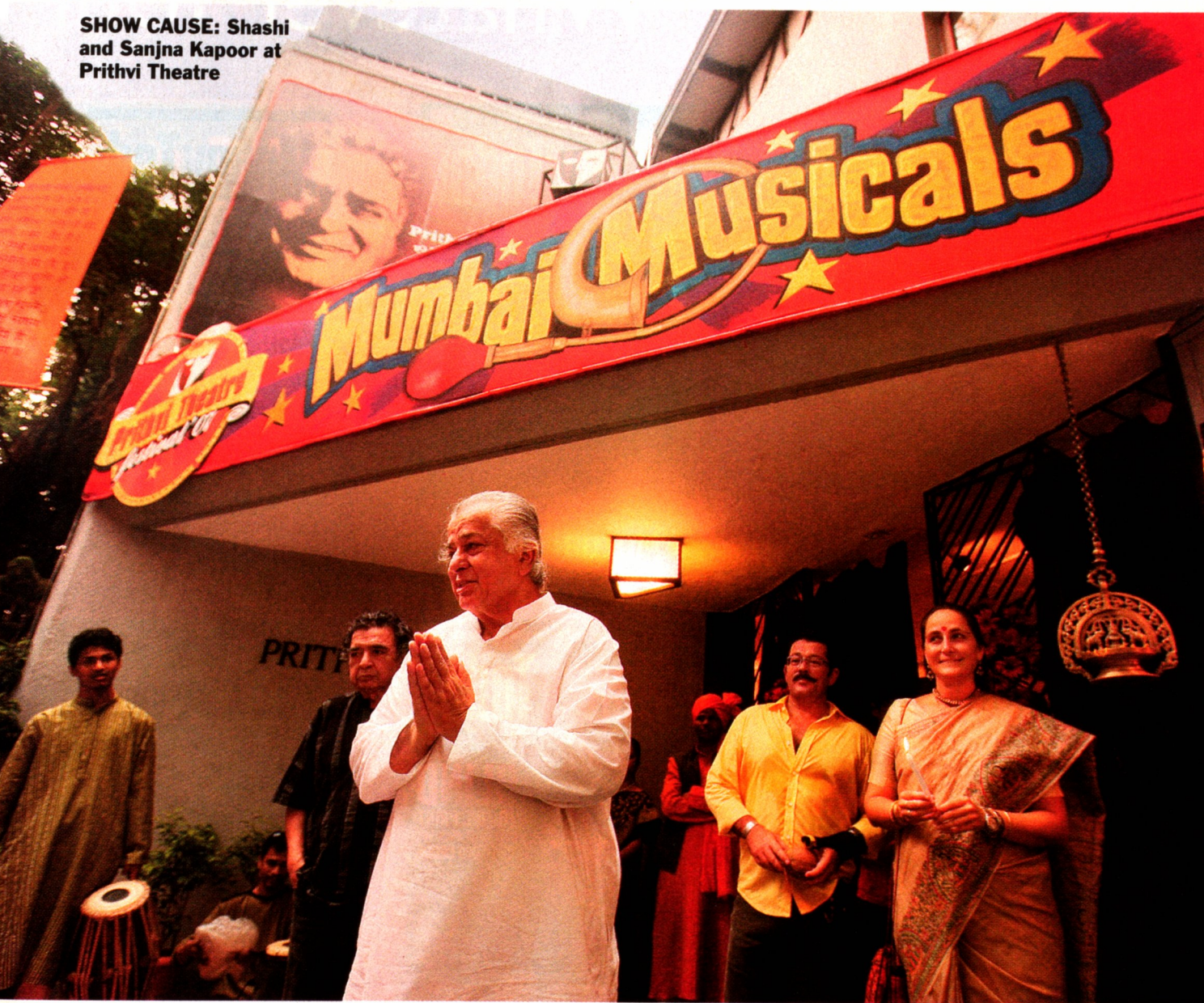


BHASKAR PAUL

SHOW CAUSE: Shashi and Sanjna Kapoor at Prithvi Theatre



ACT AND ACTIVITY

"THE ONLY NO-NOS ARE LATE ENTRY AND CELL PHONES. WE ENDEAVOUR TO SEE THAT EVERYTHING ELSE IS MADE POSSIBLE."

SANJNA KAPOOR,
 DIRECTOR, PRITHVI THEATRE



THEATRE SPACE | PRITHVI THEATRE, MUMBAI

With just a few inches between the actor and the audience, over 200 pairs of eyes are focused on the stage. Welcome to Prithvi Theatre, whose efforts to make theatre affordable for the audience and sustainable for artistes have made it possible for Mumbaikars to watch quality performances at subsidised rates. Says Sanjna Kapoor, director of Prithvi, "The idea is to welcome you into a theatre space, which is why we have no guards in uniform or gates." In the last 29 years, Prithvi has not only encouraged regular theatre—over 400 shows are held in a year—it also undertakes collaborative projects with theatre groups across the country and from abroad. Where else would you get to watch Naseeruddin Shah or theatre stars like Simon McBurney from the UK perform at Rs 100? And in the packed auditorium, you might just find actor Aamir Khan or filmmaker Anand Patwardhan jostling for space next to you. Theatre doesn't get more intimate than this. *by Nirmala Ravindran*